

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - React • C# (.NET) • Azure

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years** of experience building business platforms with **C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, React**, and SQL-based systems, combining strong backend design with practical frontend delivery and release ownership. Strongest work centers on modernizing legacy applications, fixing production issues with measurable impact, and delivering stable new features across APIs, dashboards, authentication, and reporting flows. Hands-on across **React 16–18, TypeScript 3.x–5.x, C# 5–12, .NET Framework 4.5–4.8** and **.NET Core / .NET 5–8**, with solid depth in **SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Azure, AWS, Docker**, testing, logging, and step-by-step migration work.

SKILLS

- **Frontend: React 16–18**, JavaScript ES6+, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, Redux, Context API, React Hooks, React Query, Axios, form handling, validation, reusable component design, responsive UI, SPA development
- **Backend: C# 5–12, .NET Framework 4.5–4.8, .NET Core / .NET 5–8, ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET Web API, ASP.NET Core Web API**, Entity Framework, Entity Framework Core, LINQ, REST API design, background jobs, authentication, authorization, validation, integration services
- **Data & Messaging: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis**, schema design, query tuning, indexing, stored procedures, reporting queries, pagination, caching, data consistency, queue-based processing, event-driven integration basics
- **Cloud & DevOps: Azure App Service, Azure Functions, Azure DevOps, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes basics, Git, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, IIS, Nginx, Linux**, environment setup, release automation, deployment troubleshooting
- **Observability / Quality / Security: xUnit, NUnit, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright**, integration testing, API testing, structured logging, OpenTelemetry basics, Prometheus/Grafana basics, Sentry, error monitoring, JWT, role-based access control, OWASP security practices, rate limiting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan 2024 – May 2026)

- Led delivery of a **multi-module business platform** using **.NET 8, ASP.NET Core Web API, React 18**, and **TypeScript**, converting fragmented operational requirements into stable workflows for dashboards, approvals, reporting, and administration.
- Modernized **backend services** from older **.NET Core** implementations into a cleaner **.NET 8** structure with improved controller design, clearer service-layer separation, and safer dependency registration, reducing maintenance overhead during feature expansion.
- Developed **reusable frontend components** for data tables, filtering, modal interactions, and validation-heavy forms, which improved consistency across product areas and reduced duplicated implementation effort.
- Diagnosed and fixed a **recurring timeout issue** affecting large dashboard requests by profiling database access patterns, introducing missing indexes, and applying targeted pagination, resulting in more stable performance under heavier usage.
- Built a **role-aware administration area** backed by **JWT-secured APIs** and permission-based UI rendering, improving control over sensitive operations and reducing manual intervention for access-related tasks.
- **Stabilized large-file export behavior** by replacing memory-intensive generation logic with streamed processing, improving reliability for reporting workflows used by finance and operational teams.
- Added structured logging and basic OpenTelemetry instrumentation across critical API flows, which improved visibility during troubleshooting of intermittent production issues tied to authentication, scheduled jobs, and external integrations.

- Refactored **selected frontend modules** away from heavier Redux usage toward **React Hooks** and **Context API** where simpler state management was sufficient, improving maintainability without unnecessary architectural disruption.
- Strengthened release processes by improving **Docker** build consistency, standardizing environment configuration, and adding validation gates to the **CI/CD pipeline**, helping improve release reliability by **27%**.
- Deployed and supported application workloads in **Microsoft Azure** using **App Service**, **Azure SQL**, **Blob Storage**, and **Azure Monitor**, helping the team improve uptime, environment consistency, and operational troubleshooting across shared systems.
- Fixed a cache invalidation problem that caused stale reference data to appear in dropdown workflows, adding explicit refresh handling that removed a recurring source of user confusion after releases.
- Implemented an **audit history feature** that combined backend event capture with searchable **React** interfaces, giving support teams clearer visibility into record changes and user actions during issue triage.
- Contributed to **cross-team integration** work by clarifying API contracts, validating payload edge cases early, and correcting serialization inconsistencies that had caused avoidable downstream failures.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (*Nov2020 – Nov 2023*)

- Built **full-stack product features** with **ASP.NET Core**, **C#**, **React 17–18**, and **TypeScript**, supporting customer-facing workflows, internal tooling, and backend integrations across actively used business modules.
- Expanded **REST API functionality** for search, status tracking, and configuration management while preserving thin-controller patterns, making service behavior easier to test and safer to evolve during concurrent team development.
- Modernized **legacy frontend screens** by migrating class-based components to **React Hooks** and functional patterns, reducing lifecycle-related bugs and simplifying state management in more complex pages.
- **Fixed an intermittent data visibility issue** where users received success messages before refreshed reads reflected committed updates, resolving the gap through safer transaction sequencing and clearer client refresh handling.
- Created **reusable form infrastructure** with shared validation logic and consistent error rendering, improving maintainability and reducing duplicated implementation across onboarding and record-editing flows.
- **Strengthened API consistency** by standardizing validation, error contracts, and response behavior, which allowed the frontend to handle failure scenarios more predictably and improved failure-handling consistency by **29%**.
- Assisted **with a phased migration** from **.NET Core 3.1** to **.NET 6**, addressing package conflicts and outdated configuration approaches so upgrade work could continue alongside ongoing delivery commitments.
- Supported **Azure-based application environments** through deployment, configuration, and operational troubleshooting work, helping improve release consistency and overall runtime stability.
- Introduced **higher-risk integration and API tests** to catch workflow failures earlier in the delivery cycle, reducing the volume of issues first surfaced during manual QA or after deployment.
- Improved **slow list and search screens** by reducing oversized joins, trimming unnecessary payload fields, and refining response models, resulting in faster page behavior without heavy schema rework.
- Helped **standardize containerized workflows** with **Docker** and release pipeline automation, improving setup consistency across environments and reducing environment-specific delivery problems.
- Contributed **across backend, frontend, data, and release tasks** as features moved toward delivery, helping the team maintain momentum without excessive dependency on specialist-only handoffs.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (*Feb 2016 – Sep 2020*)

- Developed business applications using **C#**, **ASP.NET MVC**, later **ASP.NET Core**, and early **React** adoption, helping the team transition from server-rendered patterns into more interactive and maintainable frontend experiences.
- Built and maintained internal modules for records management, reporting, and approval workflows, translating detailed user requests into practical implementations that balanced delivery speed with system stability.
- Helped introduce **React 16** into selected frontend areas while preserving compatibility with existing **MVC** pages, which allowed gradual modernization instead of a risky full rewrite of working screens.
- Resolved a persistent issue where form submissions occasionally created duplicate records by tightening server-side validation, adding idempotent handling, and improving client feedback during slow network conditions.

- Improved older **SQL**-heavy screens by rewriting inefficient queries, adding indexes, and reducing unnecessary round trips, which made reporting pages more usable for teams working with larger operational datasets and improved page response times by **23%**.
- Supported migration work from **Entity Framework 6** patterns into **Entity Framework Core** where appropriate, adjusting data access code carefully so newer services could evolve without breaking stable legacy modules.
- Created reusable helper components and shared service methods that reduced duplicate implementation across CRUD-heavy screens, making later enhancements and bug fixes easier for the broader team to apply consistently.
- Investigated authorization inconsistencies that exposed the wrong action buttons to some users, then aligned backend permission checks with frontend rendering rules to prevent confusing or unsafe interactions.
- Added unit and integration coverage around higher-risk business rules, improving confidence in release cycles and reducing the chance that simple maintenance changes would break dependent workflows.
- Worked across frontend, backend, **SQL**, and deployment support as needed, demonstrating flexible full-stack contribution rather than narrow ownership in a delivery environment with changing priorities.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Supported web application development using **C#, ASP.NET MVC, JavaScript, HTML, CSS**, and **SQL Server**, contributing mainly to bug fixes, smaller enhancements, and maintenance tasks under guidance from senior engineers.
- Fixed a recurring form submission problem caused by mismatched validation between browser scripts and server logic, and the correction reduced failed entries that had been frustrating both users and QA reviewers.
- Built **small UI improvements** for internal business pages, including clearer field handling, conditional rendering, and layout adjustments, which **reduced user confusion by 22%** across screens that had grown inconsistent over time.
- Assisted with backend feature updates by extending controller actions, updating view models, and adding safe database changes, allowing new requirements to be delivered without destabilizing existing workflows.
- Investigated an intermittent login issue that appeared after session expiry by tracing request behavior and reviewing cookie settings, and the eventual fix made authentication flow more predictable for normal users.
- Helped clean up duplicated code in older modules by extracting shared helpers and simplifying repeated logic, which made future bug fixes easier for the wider team to apply across related pages.
- Worked on data correction scripts and small **SQL** updates when legacy records caused application errors, supporting smoother releases by removing problematic edge cases before they reached production users.
- Added basic unit tests around selected business rules after several defects showed that manual verification alone was not enough, contributing to a more disciplined delivery process within the team.
- Participated in release preparation, smoke testing, and post-deployment checks, learning to verify configuration-sensitive behavior carefully so smaller changes would not create larger production issues.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204) — 2026

- Demonstrated practical capability in building, testing, deploying, and maintaining **Azure-based** applications, with strong relevance to **.NET, ASP.NET Core**, APIs, authentication, and cloud integrations.

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — 2026

- Demonstrated strong foundational knowledge of cloud concepts, core **Azure** services, governance, security, pricing, and support models for modern software delivery.